

2 Mobile phone features

There are certain features which affect the choice pan category and can affect your decision while buying a phone.

2.1 Input methods

This decides how you interact with the phone, whether it may be the repetitive press of a numpad, the speed of the QWERTY pad or your gentle touch.

Generic numpad: This is your regular 12-button keypad, available on most phones. This ensures the width of the phone remains in a reasonable limit and it fits inside your tight pocket without any major discomfort and is best for messaging and making calls. Generally available and best suited for non-smartphone users. If you want to use your phone as a phone, go for this.

Full QWERTY keypad: If you are a chronic SMS junkie or business professional, the speed and convenience of a full QWERTY keypad can't be underestimated. It makes composing those long SMS full of relationship advice or the email to your boss a lot more feasible, fast and fun. There are also certain modified versions available in the form of half-QWERTY keypads, where each key corresponds to 2 characters (instead of 3 on a normal numpad or 1 on a full QWERTY keypad).

The downside of a QWERTY keypad is generally either the phone becoming too wide, or the keys becoming too small to type comfortably

To touch or not: Not that there weren't touch screen phones available before the iPhone, but after that they have hit mainstream. Since with the touch screen input method there isn't a real need for a physical keypad, and that space can be utilised for a big screen, it becomes a major advantage. Though speeds of a full QWERTY keypad aren't exactly attainable on a touch screen, the pros of a bigger screen and a wonderful web



Full QWERTY keypad for speedy typing